Riana Steyn

PHYSIOTHERAPIST · BSC · HPCSA REGISTERED

riana.steyn@physio.co.za · +27 82 887 4411 · Bloemfontein, Free State · HPCSA: PT0040321

PROFILE

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Experienced and methodical Physiotherapist with 12 years of specialist practice in chronic pain and spinal rehabilitation across the Free State's private and academic health sectors. Cognitive Functional Therapy trained with a strong background in pain neuroscience education and graded exposure therapy. Lecturer in physiotherapy at the University of the Free State on a part-time basis.

EXPERIENCE

2018 – Now

Senior Physiotherapist — Chronic Pain & Spinal Rehab

Universitas Academic Hospital — Bloemfontein, FS

– Specialist chronic pain and spinal outpatient caseload — 18 patients daily.
– Applies Cognitive Functional Therapy (CFT) model for complex low back pain.
– Part-time lecturer in pain science and clinical reasoning, UFS (2020–present).
– Supervises MSc Physiotherapy students and community service physiotherapists.
– Published 2 case studies in the South African Journal of Physiotherapy.

2012 – 2018

Physiotherapist

Mediclinic Bloemfontein — Bloemfontein, FS

– Managed mixed MSK and spinal outpatient caseload.
– Completed McKenzie Part A & B and commenced CFT training during this period.
– Introduced Pain Neuroscience Education group sessions — 12 patients per session.

2011 – 2012

Community Service Physiotherapist

Pelonomi Hospital — Bloemfontein, FS

– Completed community service in mixed orthopaedic, neurological and chest wards.

SKILLS & QUALIFICATIONS

Chronic Pain & CFT
Cognitive Functional Therapy, pain neuroscience, graded exposure

Spinal Rehab
Lumbar, cervical, disc, McKenzie, post-surgical

Manual Therapy
Maitland Level 4, MFR, soft tissue

Exercise Therapy
Motor control, graded activity, Pilates-based

Assessment
ODI, NDI, PSEQ, TSK, pain catastrophising scale

Teaching
Undergraduate lectures, MSc supervision, CPD delivery

EDUCATION & CERTS

BSc Physiotherapy

University of the Free State — 2011 Distinction

HPCSA Registered

Maitland Level 4 (2017)

CFT Trained — O'Sullivan (2020)

McKenzie Part A & B

BLS Certified

SASP Member — 12 years

LANGUAGES

Afrikaans (Home Language)

English (Fluent)